

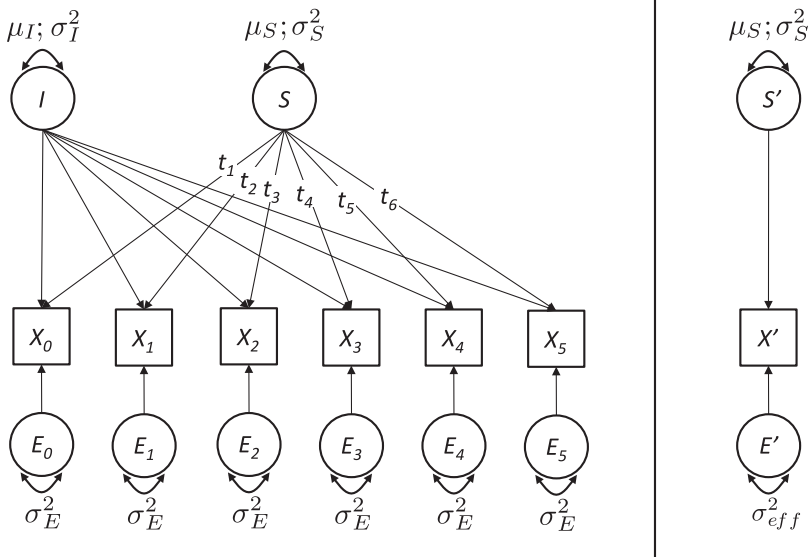


Figure 1. Left: LGCM with a latent intercept I with mean μ_I and variance σ_I^2 and a latent slope S with mean μ_S and variance σ_S^2 . Slope and intercept are uncorrelated. A single variable is observed on six occasions of measurement and with an error term of zero mean and variance σ_E^2 . Commonly, the factor loading t_1 is set to zero to set the first measurement as baseline. Right: A power-equivalent minimal model to the model on the left-hand side. It allows the interpretation that a single latent variable S' of interest with the same distribution as the slope variable S in the left model could have been measured directly with a hypothetical variance of measurement error σ_{eff}^2 .